Buddhism and Jainism

1. Why new religious movements emerged

Mid-first millennium BCE: Buddhism, Jainism and other **shramana** traditions grew amid the mahajanapadas and the **second urbanisation, c.600–300 BCE**. They challenged Vedic ritual authority and offered paths of ethical conduct and liberation. They were independent traditions, not simply branches of a single reform organisation.

Change	Connection with religious change
Varna hierarchy and priestly privileges	Kshatriya rulers, merchants and others questioned hereditary ritual superiority; Buddha and Mahavira belonged to Kshatriya clans
Agriculture expanded into eastern UP–Bihar	Iron tools, fertile land and cattle-assisted cultivation increased surplus; criticism of animal sacrifice appealed to cultivators. This is an explanatory connection, not proof that sacrifice alone obstructed farming
Towns, crafts, exchange and punch-marked coins	Merchants/artisans sought recognition and peaceful conditions for trade; donations supported wandering teachers and monasteries
Social conflict and inequality	Non-violence, truth, generosity, restraint and accessible teaching offered ethical answers to insecurity and suffering
Intellectual debate	Questions about self, rebirth, karma and liberation circulated among Brahmanical thinkers and renouncers; no single economic cause explains every doctrine

Urban centres to recognise: **Rajagriha, Shravasti, Varanasi, Vaishali, Champa, Kaushambi, Ujjaini and, later, Pataliputra**. Do not assume all were equally developed throughout 600–300 BCE. Confucius and Greek thinkers provide a wider background of inquiry; **Zoroaster's dates are disputed**, so do not put all these teachers in one securely dated sixth-century cohort.



2. Buddha: life, places and symbols

Buddha = awakened one; Siddhartha Gautama = Shakyamuni / Tathagata. Traditional accounts combine history with sacred biography. **563–483 BCE** is the conventional chronology used in the chapter; other chronologies place his

life/death later. Retain the sequence without treating these exact years as settled archaeological facts.

Stage	Essential recall
Birth	**Lumbini**, present-day Nepal, near the Shakya territory of Kapilavastu; father **Suddhodana**, Shakya chief; mother **Mahamaya/Maya**; raised by **Mahaprajapati Gautami** after Maya's death, traditionally seven days after birth; **Vaishakha Purnima** birth festival tradition
Family	Tradition names **Yashodhara** as wife (marriage traditionally at **16**) and **Rahula** as son; **32 mahapurusha marks** underpin the sacred prediction of universal ruler or renouncer. Maya is usually associated with the **Koliya** clan; do not confuse **Koliya** with **Kosala**, the larger kingdom connected with Shakya territory
Four sights	Old age, sickness, death and an ascetic → inquiry into suffering
Great Renunciation / Mahabhinishkramana	Traditionally at **29**; attendant **Channa**, horse **Kanthaka**
Search	Teachers **Alara Kalama** and **Uddaka Ramaputta**; severe austerities with five ascetics; rejected self-mortification; **Sujata's milk-rice offering** belongs to the sacred life narrative—her caste should not be asserted from an unverified label
Enlightenment / Bodhi	Traditionally at **35**, after six years' search; **Uruvela/Bodh Gaya**, beside **Niranjana**, under the **peepal/Bodhi tree**
First sermon	**Deer Park, Isipatana/Rishipattana, Sarnath**, near Varanasi; **Dhammachakkappavattana / Dharmachakrapravartana** = setting the Dhamma wheel in motion
First five companions	**Kondanna, Vappa, Bhaddiya, Mahanama, Assaji**; the first core of the monastic community
Teaching and final passing	Taught for over four decades; **Mahaparinibbana/Mahaparinirvana at Kushinara/Kushinagar**, in **Malla** territory, traditionally aged **80**

Kosala and Magadha are the kingdoms most directly associated with his life in the recurring PYQ; **Avanti and Gandhara** are distractors in that question. Kushinara's Malla affiliation and Sarnath's location should still be retained separately.

Symbols and gestures

Symbol	Recall
Lotus; bull in conventional exam symbolism	Birth; bull relates to the traditional birth association, not every depiction
Riderless horse	Great Renunciation
Bodhi tree / empty seat	Enlightenment / Buddha's presence in early narrative art
Wheel	First sermon and Dhamma
Footprints	Buddha's presence/path; **not exclusively the death scene**
Stupa; reclining Buddha in later imagery	Mahaparinirvana / relic veneration
Bhumisparsha mudra	Right hand touches the earth: calls the earth to witness the merit leading to awakening against **Mara's** challenge

Narratives of attempts on the Bodhi tree name **Tissarakkha under Ashoka**, **Pushyamitra Shunga in the second century BCE**, and **Shashanka in the early seventh century CE**. Their details come from later religious accounts and have differing historical reliability; do not present every destruction episode or a precise **600 CE** date as independently proven.

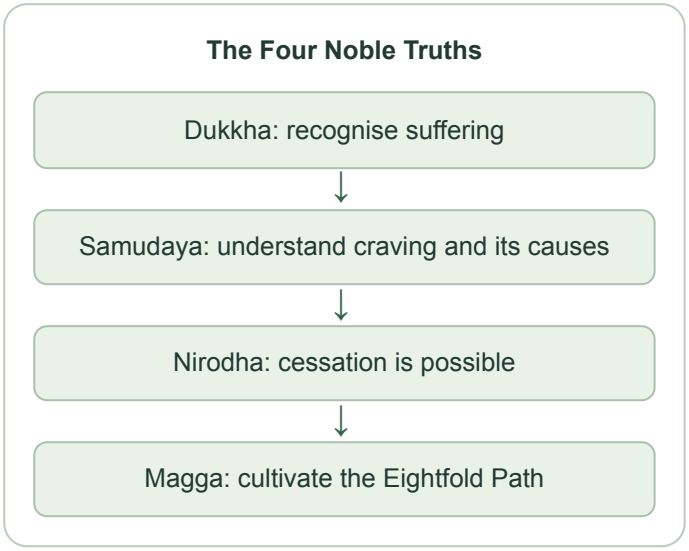
3. Buddhist teaching: the shortest complete map

Three jewels: distinguish from the Jaina three jewels

Buddha = teacher/awakened one → Dhamma = teaching/path → Sangha = community of practitioners, especially the monastic order. Lay followers are **upasakas** and **upasikas**; monks and nuns are **bhikkhus** and **bhikkhunis**.

Four Noble Truths

Truth	Meaning
Dukkha	Conditioned existence is marked by suffering, instability and unsatisfactoriness; not merely physical pain
Samudaya	Craving/**tanha/trishna**, tied to ignorance and attachment, produces suffering
Nirodha	Cessation of craving/suffering is possible: **Nibbana/Nirvana**
Magga/Marga	The **Noble Eightfold Path** leads to cessation



Eightfold Path: remember 2 + 3 + 3

Training	Right factors	Practical meaning
Wisdom / panna-prajna	**View** (*samma-ditthi*); **intention/thought** (*samma-sankappa*)	Understand reality; cultivate renunciation, goodwill and harmlessness
Ethical conduct / sila	**Speech** (*vaca*); **action** (*kammanta*); **livelihood** (*ajiva*)	Avoid false/harmful speech, harmful acts and exploitative occupations

Training	Right factors	Practical meaning
Mental discipline / samadhi	**Effort** (*vayama*); **mindfulness** (*sati*); **concentration** (*samadhi*)	Prevent/unlearn unwholesome states, sustain awareness and train attention

Middle Path: avoids both sensual indulgence and extreme self-mortification. It is not indifference between ethical and unethical conduct. The first sermon connects the Middle Way, Four Truths and Eightfold Path. Primary discourse, SN 56.11.

Five precepts and renunciation

Abstain from killing → taking what is not given → sexual misconduct → false speech → intoxicants causing heedlessness. Lay sexual ethics concern misconduct; monastic discipline requires celibacy. Renunciants also follow rules concerning eating after noon, entertainment/adornment, luxurious beds and money; **the complete Vinaya is much larger than "five plus three" rules**.

Karma, self and liberation

- **Anicca/anitya:** impermanence. **Anatta/anatman:** no permanent, independent self. Buddhism accepts **karma and rebirth without a transmigrating eternal atman**.
- **Karma is intentional action**, not merely priestly ritual; ethical intention, speech and bodily action have consequences.
- **Nirvana:** extinguishing greed/craving, hatred and delusion; achievable during life. **Not physical death, annihilation of an eternal soul, or a temporary heavenly holiday.** Final passing of the liberated is parinirvana.
- Buddhism does not ground liberation in a **creator God**, but traditional cosmologies contain **devas, heavens, hells, hungry ghosts and other rebirth realms**. The source table's "no heaven or hell" claim is wrong. Canonical examples, Itivuttaka.
- The **ten realms** sequence in the chapter—Buddha, bodhisattva, pratyekabuddha, shravaka, devas, humans, asuras, animals, pretas and hell beings—is a **later classificatory scheme**, not the one universal early Buddhist cosmology. The last are **hell beings**, not a social class of "depraved men".
- **Ahimsa** is central; early monastic acceptance of certain donated meat means **all Buddhists were not uniformly vegetarian**. Rules differ by tradition; this does not license killing specifically to feed monks.
- Teachings as a **raft**: use the path to cross suffering; do not turn attachment to doctrine into another obstacle. **Upaya** = skilful means, especially developed in Mahayana thought.

4. Sangha, women and social limits

The Sangha spread teaching through itinerant preaching, rainy-season residence, collective discipline and lay patronage. It offered spiritual recognition beyond inherited varna; **Upali**, traditionally a barber, stands beside Brahmana disciples **Sariputta, Mahamoggallana and Mahakassapa** and Kshatriya figures **Ananda and Aniruddha**. **Chunda**, associated with the final meal, is traditionally a smith.

- **Mahaprajapati Gautami:** first nun in the traditional account; **Ananda** intercedes for women's admission. Nuns such as **Khema, Uppalavanna/Utpalavarna, Dhammadinna, Sumedha and Sumangalamata** illustrate women's religious agency; **Therigatha** preserves elder nuns' verses.
- **Ambapali/Amrapali of Vaishali**, **Addhakasi of Kasi** and **Padmavati of Ujjaini** illustrate inclusion of women from socially stigmatised backgrounds in Buddhist narratives.
- Traditional Vinaya accounts impose **eight garudhammas**: seniority of monks over nuns; residence near monks during rains; fortnightly instruction; joint post-rains review; joint procedure for serious offences; two-year training before full ordination; no abuse of monks; asymmetric admonition. These show **institutional inequality despite**

equal spiritual capacity. Their textual formation/historicity is debated; predictions blaming women for shortening the religion's life are not verified historical causation.

- **Not a modern abolition programme:** debts, slavery and military service could restrict admission without release/permission. Monastic communities depended on donations and generally recognised property, family obligations and political authority.
- Buddhist criticism targets **birth-based spiritual superiority**; some texts still privilege Kshatriya rank. Avoid the claim that every social distinction vanished.

Buddhism and Brahmanical/Upanishadic traditions

Shared questions: karma, rebirth, discipline, knowledge and liberation; there were **debates and borrowing as well as disagreements**. Upanishads developed within Brahmanical traditions, not simply outside them as a united anti-Brahmana movement.

Issue	Buddhism	Upanishadic traditions
Self	**Anatman**: rejects permanent self	Inquiry into **atman**, often related to **Brahman**
Ultimate reality	No necessary creator-God foundation	Diverse accounts of Brahman/ultimate reality; **Brahman is not simply the god Brahma**
Liberation	Nirvana; cessation of craving/ignorance	Moksha; explanations vary—do not reduce every school to literal merging with a personal deity
Authority	Vedas not binding authority	Located within the Vedic textual tradition

5. Buddhist literature and scholars

Canonical status varies by school. Texts were orally transmitted, edited and written down over time; the whole Tripitaka was not physically composed on leaves at the Buddha's death. **Tipitaka** is Pali; **Tripitaka** is Sanskrit: “three baskets”. The **Pali canon belongs to Theravada**; other Buddhist canons differ.

Basket	Contents and subdivisions
Sutta Pitaka	Discourses; five **Nikayas**: **Digha**—long; **Majjhima**—middle-length; **Samyutta**—connected; **Anguttara**—numerical; **Khuddaka**—smaller collection
Vinaya Pitaka	Monastic discipline, procedures and narratives; **Suttavibhanga** includes rules for monks/nuns; **Khandhaka** → **Mahavagga + Cullavagga**; **Parivara** supplementary analysis; **Patimokkha** rule collection
Abhidhamma Pitaka	Systematic analysis of mind, phenomena and doctrine; seven books: **Dhammasangani, Vibhanga, Dhatukatha, Puggalapannatti, Kathavatthu, Yamaka, Patthana**

Khuddaka recall: Jataka—former births; **Dhammapada**—ethical verses; **Theragatha/Therigatha**—elder monks/nuns; **Buddhavamsa**—Buddha lineage/history; **Niddesa**—exposition; **Patisambhidamagga**—analytical knowledge. Its number of books varies by Theravada recension; **15** is a common count, not a universal total for every Buddhist canon. Dhammapada is **canonical**, not simply a non-canonical treatise.

Work / writer	Identification
Milindapanha	Pali dialogue: **Menander/Milinda** ↔ **Nagasena**; not Nagarjuna. Its canonical standing varies regionally

Work / writer	Identification
Nettipakarana	Interpretative guide to Buddhist teaching; **Buddhist**, not Jaina
Visuddhimagga	**Buddhaghosa**, **fifth century CE**; Path of Purification, Theravada synthesis
Nidanakatha	Connected sacred life narrative associated with the Jataka commentary
Dipavamsa / Mahavamsa	Pali Sri Lankan chronicles: traditions about councils, Ashoka, missions and royal history; historical and legendary layers
Mahavastu	Sacred biography associated with **Lokottaravadins**, in Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit; not a Jaina work
Buddhacharita—Ashvaghosha	Sanskrit life of Buddha; **c.first–second centuries CE**, traditionally linked with Kanishka; poet/dramatist
Nagarjuna	**c.second–third centuries CE**, **Madhyamaka** and emptiness; Satavahana patronage traditions exist, but identification of one exact contemporary king is debated
Aryadeva	Buddhist Madhyamaka scholar; **not Jaina**
Asanga and Vasubandhu	**c.fourth–fifth centuries CE**, brothers linked with **Yogachara/Vijnanavada**; Maitreyanatha associated with its development. Vasubandhu's **Abhidharmakosha** is a major Abhidharma work
Dignaga / Dinnaga	**c.fifth–sixth centuries CE**, Buddhist logic and epistemology
Dharmakirti	**Seventh century CE**, Buddhist logic/epistemology; do not confuse with Buddhist translators of similar names

6. Councils and schools: do not collapse the timeline

Dates below are **traditional/conventional**; the earliest councils are known through later school histories. Their dating depends partly on the chronology adopted for the Buddha.

Council tradition	Place / patron / leading figure	Recall and qualification
First, shortly after Buddha's passing; conventionally c.483 BCE	**Rajagriha; Ajatashatru; Mahakassapa**	**Upali—Vinaya; Ananda—discourses**. Do not assert that the entire later Abhidhamma was already fixed in its final form
Second, about a century later; conventionally c.383 BCE	**Vaishali; Kalashoka; Sabbakami**	Discipline disputes, traditionally “ten points”. Early division into **Sthaviras and Mahasanghikas** is associated with this general period, but accounts of the schism differ
Third, c.250 BCE	**Pataliputra; Ashoka; Moggaliputta Tissa**	Theravada account of doctrinal purification, **Kathavatthu** tradition and missions; not the single moment at which every Buddhist school accepted one canon
Fourth—Sri Lankan tradition, first century BCE	**Alu Vihara/Aloka Lena; Vattagamani Abhaya**	Writing down the Pali canon is associated with this council tradition
Fourth—Sarvastivada tradition, Kanishka's reign, broadly second century CE	**Kashmir/Kundalavana; Vasumitra**; Ashvaghosha/Parshva also occur in accounts	Scholastic commentaries/**Mahavibhasha** tradition. **Not a one-day division into Mahayana and “Hinayana”**; the chapter's first-century date reflects older Kushan chronologies

The modern **c.127 CE** accession framework places Kanishka in the second century. British Museum coin chronology.

Early schools and later vehicles

- **Sthavira** = elder; **Thera** is the Pali cognate. **Theravada** is a particular surviving lineage, **not identical to every Sthavira school or all "Hinayana"**. "Hinayana" is a polemical Mahayana label, not an appropriate neutral name for all early Buddhism.
- **Mahasanghika:** early school group; **Lokottaravada** an offshoot. Its exalted conception of Buddha helped the background of later Mahayana, but **Mahasanghika ≠ Mahayana**.
- **Sarvastivada:** dharmas exist across past, present and future in its distinctive analysis; an early Buddhist school, not simply a subdivision of present-day Theravada.
- **Sautrantika:** stresses sutra authority over certain Abhidharma positions; **Sammitiya:** early Buddhist school. **Both are Buddhist, not Jaina**.

Tradition	Distinctive focus	Texts / practice / geography
Theravada: "Teaching of the Elders"	Arhat ideal; ethical discipline, meditation, wisdom; the bodhisatta career is also recognised	Pali canon; Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand and much of mainland Southeast Asia. **Images and devotional worship are practised**—"no idols" is false
Mahayana: "Great Vehicle"	**Bodhisattva ideal**, compassion and Buddhahood for all; many Buddhas/bodhisattvas; **Madhyamaka and Yogachara** major philosophical currents	Sanskrit and other textual traditions, later Chinese/Tibetan translations; East Asia and Himalayan regions. **Amitabha/Pure Land** devotion offers one important path, not the whole of Mahayana
Vajrayana: "Diamond/Thunderbolt Vehicle"	Esoteric methods within a Mahayana framework; guru/**lama**, initiation, mantra, **mandala** and visualisation	Developed across the **later first millennium CE**, prominent in eastern India, especially Bihar–Bengal; Tibetan transmissions in **eighth century** and renewed links in **eleventh century**, including Vikramashila. Tibet, Bhutan, Nepal, Mongolia and Himalayan areas

Two truths—conventional and ultimate—are important to Mahayana philosophy and Vajrayana, not exclusive to the latter. **Sandhya-bhasha** = symbolic "twilight language". Vajrayana is not reducible to acquiring magical power; **Tara** has peaceful and wrathful forms, not only fierce ones. **Ashoka predates these later vehicle labels**; Kanishka's patronage does not establish one uniform sect for his whole empire. Harsha later supported Buddhist institutions alongside other traditions.

Bodhisattvas and paramitas

Bodhisattva: one committed to awakening for the benefit of beings; Mahayana stresses compassionate assistance to all. **Paramitas = perfections on this path**: six commonly listed are **generosity, ethical conduct, patience, energy, meditation and wisdom**; an expanded ten adds skilful means, aspiration/resolution, power and knowledge. These lists vary between traditions.

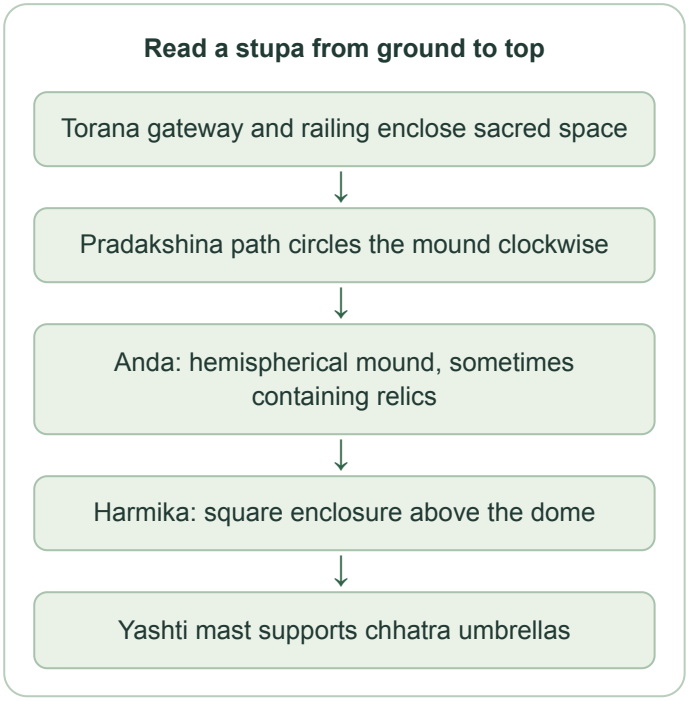
Bodhisattva	Recognition clue
Manjushri	**Wisdom**; flaming sword cuts ignorance; Prajnaparamita book; sometimes lion
Avalokiteshvara / Padmapani / Lokeshvara	**Compassion**; lotus, often Amitabha in headdress; Padmapani painting at **Ajanta**
Vajrapani	**Power/energy**; vajra, often forceful/wrathful form

Bodhisattva	Recognition clue
Maitreya	**Future Buddha**, presently a bodhisattva; waiting in Tushita; representations vary—do not define him by an “orange bush”
Kshitigarbha	Vow to aid beings, especially in hell realms; monk's robe, staff and wish-fulfilling jewel
Akashagarbha	“Space treasury”; wisdom/merit, associated with purification; iconography varies
Samantabhadra	Excellent conduct and great vows; often **six-tusked elephant**; with Shakyamuni and Manjushri in a familiar triad
Sarvanivaranavishkambhin	Removes hindrances/obscurations; lotus and varied attributes in different traditions

Three family protectors = Manjushri—wisdom; Avalokiteshvara—compassion; Vajrapani—power. Colours/attributes can differ by regional iconographic system; do not memorise one painting as a universal rule. Metropolitan Museum exhibition.

7. Stupas, caves and monastic vocabulary

Stupa = mound/heap, developed from funerary/relic traditions; **not exclusively Buddhist in origin**. In Buddhism it can hold relics, commemorate sacred events or serve as a votive object. Ashokan patronage helped make it a major sacred monument.



Medhi = raised terrace/drum or circumambulatory platform, depending on the structure; **vedika** = railing. Brick cores, stone casing, plaster and sculpted elements differ by site and building phase. **Chhatra is the umbrella; yashti is its supporting mast**. NCERT structure and terminology.

Type	Function
Relic	Bodily remains of Buddha or disciples
Object	Associated bowl, robe or other sacred objects; sometimes scriptures
Commemorative	Marks a life event or sacred place

Type	Function
Symbolic	Embodies cosmological/doctrinal ideas; **Borobudur** is a major example
Votive	Made/offered to earn merit or express devotion; miniature terracotta examples became especially common in India from the **seventh century CE**; stone/metal examples also occur

Tradition distributes Buddha's relics among **eight recipients**: Rajagriha, Vaishali, Kapilavastu, Allakappa, Ramagrama, Vethadipa, Pava and Kushinara. Additional monuments concern the **relic vessel** and the **ashes at Pipphalivana**. Do not turn these traditions into a universal statement that there were exactly nine stupas in all.

Site	Location / importance
Sanchi	MP; Ashokan brick nucleus, **third century BCE**, enlarged and embellished later; four ornate gateways, southern gateway conventionally earliest; **UNESCO 1989** (World Heritage record)
Sarnath—Dhamekh	UP; first-sermon landscape; earlier Ashokan remains, but present massive Dhamekh structure substantially **Gupta-period, c.fifth–sixth centuries CE**; “built in 249 BCE, rebuilt exactly 500 CE” is too rigid (Ministry of Tourism)
Amaravati / Dhanyakataka	Andhra Pradesh; major stupa built/altered over centuries, broadly **third century BCE–third century CE**; **Mahasanghika** Buddhist centre in PYQ
Bharhut	MP; earlier foundation conventionally attributed to Ashoka, famous surviving railings/sculpture mainly **second century BCE**; inscriptions reveal donations by lay people, monks and nuns
Piprahwa	UP; stupa/monastery complex, associated with Shakya relic traditions; identification and inscription interpretation require care
Nagarjunakonda	Andhra Pradesh, west of Amaravati; Buddhist and Brahmanical remains; multiple Buddhist schools, not only Mahayana
Sonari	MP; Sanchi-region complex; two major and several smaller stupas

Terms repeatedly tested

Term	Meaning
Chaitya / chaitya-griha	Sacred/worship space; rock-cut prayer hall commonly contains a stupa
Vihara	Monastic residence; later complexes may include shrines
Pravrajya / pabbajja	Going forth into renunciation; novice initiation
Upasampada	Full monastic ordination
Uposatha	Periodic observance and recitation/review of discipline, associated with lunar days
Parajika	Gravest offences entailing defeat/expulsion; monks' four include sexual intercourse, serious theft, intentional human killing and false claims to superhuman attainment
Pavarana / Pravarana	End-of-rains invitation to correction regarding offences; distinguishes it from routine fortnightly observance
Vassa	Rainy-season retreat/residence

Term	Meaning
Shramana / samana	Renouncer/striver; broader category than Buddhist monk
Parivrajaka / paribbajaka	Wandering renouncer
Shakra / Sakka	Indra in Buddhist contexts
Maagadha	Professional reciter of chronicles, dynastic histories and epic traditions; not the same as shramana

8. Spread, contribution and decline of Buddhism

Why it spread

Accessible ethics + teaching in vernacular linguistic settings + organised Sangha + merchants/lay donors + rulers + trade/mission networks. The language of the preserved Pali canon should not be equated mechanically with the Buddha's exact spoken dialect. Sanskrit later became an important Buddhist language, alongside many others.

- Royal/elite supporters included rulers of **Magadha and Kosala**, republican groups, **Ashoka**, later **Kushans**, **Harsha** and regional patrons. Monks/nuns and small donors also mattered; spread was not solely a royal programme.
- Sri Lankan tradition credits **Mahinda/Mahendra** and **Sanghamitta/Sanghamitra** with major missions under Ashoka; **Sona and Uttara—Suvarnabhumi**, **Mahadeva—Mahishamandala**, **Maharakkhita—Yona country**. These are **chronicle traditions**, and exact modern boundaries of mission destinations are debated. The chapter confuses names in the Himalayan mission: **Majjhima** is associated with the Himalayan region; **Dhammarakkhita** with Aparantaka.
- Monks, merchants and translators linked India, Sri Lanka, Central Asia, Southeast Asia and China. **Kumarajiva reached Chang'an in 401 CE**; **Faxian/Fa-Hien** and **Xuanzang/Hiuen Tsang** later travelled to India. Traditions of an initial first-century Chinese invitation name **Kashyapa Matanga and Dharmaratna**, not a secure itinerary for every similarly named monk.
- The source's **“Dharmadeva went to China in 1001 CE”** is not used as a firm date: identification/chronology needs verification.
- Contributions: ethical reflection, compassion, monastic education, manuscript/translation networks, stupas/caves/sculpture and donor inscriptions. Indian Buddhist World Heritage examples include **Sanchi, Ajanta, Mahabodhi at Bodh Gaya and Nalanda**; their histories are distinct, not all Ashokan constructions.

Why it declined in many Indian regions

A long, uneven process—not disappearance everywhere from one year. Patronage and trade patterns changed; some large endowed monasteries became vulnerable; devotional Brahmanical traditions competed, absorbed Buddhist figures and offered alternative networks; institutional concentration and regional politics mattered. Warfare and attacks on monasteries, especially in the **late twelfth–early thirteenth centuries**, intensified losses in parts of northern/eastern India.

Claims that Sanskrit, image worship, “corrupt monks” or any single religion alone caused decline are insufficient. Buddhism remained vigorous under some later rulers; **Gupta rulers were not uniformly anti-Buddhist**. Accounts of persecution by **Pushyamitra**, **Mihirakula** and **Shashanka** have different evidential strengths and should not be fused into one continuous empire-wide policy. Buddhist traditions **survived in Himalayan and other communities and later revived**; “completely extinct in India” is false.

9. Mahavira and the Jaina tradition

Jina = conqueror of passions; Tirthankara = ford-maker who teaches a path across rebirth. Jainism recognises **24 Tirthankaras in each half-cycle**. Mahavira is the **24th**, not the first founder of an entirely new tradition. Historicity is firmer for the last teachers than for the whole sacred lineage.

Tirthankara	Recall
1. Rishabha / Adinatha	**Bull** emblem; traditional first Tirthankara. Similar names in Vedic/Puranic literature do not by themselves prove an exact historical identification
19. Malli / Mallinatha	Female Tirthankara in Shvetambara tradition; male in Digambara tradition
22. Neminatha / Arishtanemi	Saurashtra/Girnar association
23. Parshvanatha	Varanasi/Benaras; serpent emblem; fourfold restraint tradition
24. Vardhamana Mahavira	**Lion** emblem; Jitendriya/Arihant; systematised the five great vows

Mahavira: traditional life sequence

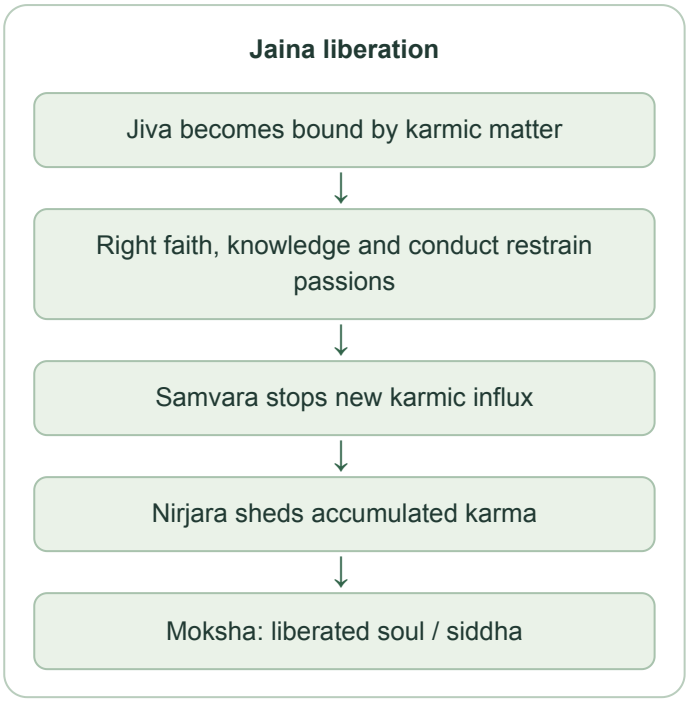
- **599–527 BCE** is the traditional chronology used here; other historical chronologies differ. Broadly a contemporary of Buddha; do not infer exact synchronisms from every traditional date.
- Born at **Kundagrama near Vaishali**, in the **Jnatrika/Naya** Kshatriya clan; father **Siddhartha**, mother **Trishala**. Linked by tradition to the Lichchhavis and **Chetaka**, with varying kinship accounts. Vaishali was a centre of the **Vajji confederacy**; do not call it simply the capital of monarchical Videha.
- **Shvetambara tradition:** wife **Yashoda**, daughter **Priyadarshana**; renunciation at **30** after a householder's life. **Digambara tradition:** unmarried; other details also differ.
- After **12 years** of austerity, attained **kevalajnana**, traditionally aged **42**, beside **Rijupalika/Rijubalika**, near **Jrimbhikagrama**, associated with a householder **Samaga**.
- Final liberation, traditionally aged **72**, at **Pavapuri/Pava near present-day Patna**. Keep this separate from the Buddhist sacred geography; similarly named places create traps.
- **Ganadharas:** chief disciples/transmitters of the teaching. Do not assume every disciple was already omniscient throughout his entire discipleship.

10. Jaina doctrines: soul, karma and many-sided truth

Jiva = soul/conscious living substance. Jainism accepts enduring individual souls and no creator of the universe. The world operates through its own eternal constituents/order; **universal soul is not its creator**. Gods are recognised as beings within samsara, below the spiritually liberated Jinas in the relevant hierarchy.

Principle	Meaning and exam distinction
Anekantavada	Reality has multiple aspects; one finite standpoint does not exhaust it. Blind-men-and-elephant illustration. **Not “every contradictory claim is equally correct”**
Syadavada	Conditional predication: **syat = in a certain respect / under stated conditions**; not mere indecision or random “maybe”
Nayavada	Analysis from partial standpoints/**nayas**, without mistaking one for the whole truth
Kevalajnana	Perfect/complete knowledge; finite observers know only aspects

Principle	Meaning and exam distinction
Karmic bondage	Karmic matter binds the soul through activity/passions; **meritorious as well as demeritorious karma can bind**, not only “bad deeds”
Asrava → bandha	Influx → bondage of karma
Samvara → nirjara → moksha	Stop new influx → shed accumulated karma → liberation



Three jewels / Triratna

Samyag-darshana = right faith/perception → samyag-jnana = right knowledge → samyag-charitra = right conduct. These are **not** the Buddhist Buddha–Dhamma–Sangha triad.

Five great vows

Vow	Recall
Ahimsa	Non-injury in **thought, speech and action**; neither commit, commission nor approve harm. Care extends to minute life; combines intention, vigilance and restraint rather than dismissing all unintended physical harm
Satya	Truthful, responsible speech; avoid speech causing needless injury
Asteya / achaurya	Do not take what is not given, including by unfair means; restraint in alms/consumption
Brahmacharya	Complete celibacy for ascetics; chastity/restraint for householders. Traditionally made a separate fifth vow by Mahavira alongside Parshva's four
Aparigraha	Non-possession/non-attachment; limit desires and accumulation

Mahavratas: full ascetic vows. **Anuvratas:** limited householders' vows, not a Buddhist sect. **Sallekhana:** religious discipline of gradual fasting and detachment approaching death under prescribed conditions; not a recommendation that every follower must fast to death.

Life and cosmology

- Time cycles between ascending **utsarpini** and descending **avasarpini**, each with **six aras/stages**; the present traditional half-cycle is descending. No supported historical year is assigned to mythic cycles.
- Living beings include gods, humans, hell beings and animals/plants. **Ekendriya** = one-sensed life; **nigoda** = extremely minute forms of life in Jaina doctrine. Earth-, water-, fire-, air- and plant-bodied living beings explain the exceptionally wide scope of ahimsa. **Not a modern scientific assertion that every physical atom is an individual soul**.
- **Dravya** = substance; **guna** = quality; **paryaya** = mode. Six substances commonly counted: **jiva, pudgala/matter, dharma/motion-medium, adharma/rest-medium, akasha/space and kala/time**. Here **dharma/adharma do not mean merit/sin**.
- Additional terms: **pudgala**—matter/atomic aggregates; **chaitanya**—consciousness; **virya**—energy; **mohaniya**—deluding karma; **gunasthanas**—stages of purification; **avadhijnana**—limited supersensory knowledge, not omniscience; **arhat/arihant**—embodied conqueror with perfect knowledge; **siddha**—fully liberated; **basadi**—Jaina temple/establishment, especially Karnataka; **eva** simply means “indeed”, not a separate substance.
- Strict ahimsa encouraged vegetarianism and avoidance of livelihoods causing injury. **Trade became important, but all Jains were not prohibited from every form of cultivation or confined to commerce in actual history**; Jaina patrons included rulers and diverse communities.

11. Jaina literature, councils and spread

Texts and transmission

Agama / Siddhanta = sacred teaching/textual tradition; the early material was orally transmitted, especially in **Ardhamagadhi Prakrit**. Later authors used **other Prakrits, Sanskrit, Apabhramsha, Kannada, Tamil** and more languages. The two principal traditions do not recognise an identical surviving canon.

- **Angas**: traditionally **12**, but the **twelfth, Drishtivada, is lost**; **11 survive in the Shvetambara canon**. **Acharanga/Acaranga** and **Sutrakritanga** are major early texts. Do not claim 12 complete surviving Angas. Jainpedia—Angas.
- **Purvas** = ancient/previous teachings; **shruta-kevalin** = master of the scriptural tradition, distinct from the kevalin's direct omniscience. **Angabahya** = texts outside the Angas.
- Conventional Shvetambara categories: **12 Upangas**, **10 Prakirnakas** (miscellanies), **6 Chedasutras** (discipline), **4 Mulasutras** (basic instruction), plus **Nandi** and **Anuyogadvara**; accepted collections differ among subtraditions.
- **Kalpasutra** is an important Shvetambara text with Tirthankara lives and monastic material. **Tattvarthasutra**, associated with **Umasvati/Umasvami**, is a systematic doctrinal work respected across the main traditions, with variant versions.
- **Digambaras** hold the original Angas lost and preserve a different scriptural corpus; this is not absence of literature.
- **Divya-dhvani / samavasarana:** teaching of an omniscient Jina in a universal preaching assembly; Digambara and Shvetambara accounts differ over the nature of the sound/language.

Later work	Author / period / content
Harivamsha Purana	**Eighth century CE** Jaina work; Jaina versions of Krishna/Balarama and epic lineages; distinguish similarly named Brahmanical works
Adi Purana	**Ninth century CE**; Rishabha/Adinatha narrative; Jinasena associated with the Sanskrit work

Later work	Author / period / content
Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana	**Jinasena and Gunabhadra, ninth century CE**; lives of illustrious beings and kings, with social/ritual/political material; **Jaina**
Parishishtaparvan	**Hemachandra, twelfth century CE**; Jaina teachers and political traditions; **Jaina**, unlike Nettipakarana/Avadanashataka

Councils and sect formation

Council tradition	Essential recall
Pataliputra, c.fourth–third centuries BCE	Associated with **Sthulabhadra** and recovery/arrangement of the Angas; chapter's **310 BCE** is a conventional teaching date, not established exact chronology; rejected as authoritative by Digambara tradition
Vallabhi, fifth–sixth centuries CE	**Devarddhigani Kshamashramana**; writing/redaction of the Shvetambara canon. Dates vary: **453/466 CE** occur in scholarship; **512 CE** occurs in conventional Indian teaching accounts. Remember place, presiding figure and purpose; **do not force all accounts into one exact year** (IGNOU teaching chronology)

Bhadrabahu–southern migration and **Sthulabhadra–Magadha** are associated in later traditions with a twelve-year famine and emerging differences. **Chandragupta Maurya's Jaina renunciation at Shravanabelagola** is a later traditional association. Do not treat a single famine as a fully documented instantaneous split; Digambara/Shvetambara identities crystallised gradually over the early centuries CE.

Spread: Gangetic beginnings → **Karnataka and other southern regions**, **Tamil-Brahmi Jaina associations by the last centuries BCE**, **Kalinga**, and western/central centres in **Gujarat, Rajasthan and Malwa**. **Kharavela of Kalinga**, conventionally **first century BCE**, patronised the Jaina tradition; **he was not a fourth-century BCE king**. Mercantile networks, householders, temples, libraries, literary activity and regional patrons helped continuity. Jainism received less extensive early transregional royal patronage than Buddhism, but “no royal patronage” is false.

12. Jaina sects and subsects

Aspect	Digambara—sky-clad	Shvetambara—white-clad
Ascetic clothing	Full male mendicant ideal includes nudity; female renouncers/**aryikas** wear clothes	Mendicants wear white; nudity not necessary for liberation
Women's liberation	Traditional doctrine requires male rebirth for final liberation	Women can attain liberation; **Malli** accepted as female Tirthankara
Omniscient's food	Kevalin no longer needs ordinary food	Kevalin may still take food
Mahavira's life	Traditionally unmarried; rejects embryo-transfer narrative	Yashoda/Priyadarshana tradition; narrative of embryo transfer from **Devananda to Trishala** by divine agency
Scripture	Original Angas lost; own authoritative texts	Surviving Agamas accepted, with subsect variations
Images	Generally nude, unadorned, contemplative	Commonly clothed/ornamented, sometimes inset eyes; image worship is not followed by every subsect

Aspect	Digambara—sky-clad	Shvetambara—white-clad
Mendicant practice	Traditionally food in cupped palms, standing, once daily; feather broom/**picchi** and water-pot are permitted implements, not worldly ownership	Alms collection and permitted equipment/clothing under its own discipline; not unlimited possessions

Nudity applies to ascetic ideals, not every Digambara layperson. Shvetambara female mendicants are **sadhvis**, Digambara female renouncers **aryikas**; terminology can overlap more broadly.

Subsects: two different Terapanthas

Group	Recognition and practices
Digambara Bisapantha	Image worship, bhattaraka religious heads; offerings may include flowers/fruits, lamps/arati; important in southern/western communities
Digambara Terapantha	Reform against bhattaraka dominance; retains **image worship**; avoids living/sachitta offerings, uses dry offerings; traditionally no arati/prasada as in Bisapantha; prominent in north/central India
Digambara Taranapantha / Samaiyapantha	Sacred books/spiritual practice emphasised; **non-image worship**; Bundelkhand–Malwa/Khandesh associations
Digambara Gumanapantha	Austere conduct; image viewing without offerings; avoids temple lamps as injury; Rajasthan associations
Digambara Totapantha	Small tradition between Bisa/Terapantha practices; pockets of central India
Shvetambara Murtipujaka / Deravasi / Mandiramargi	Images, decorated temples, offerings; temple/upashraya associations; strong in Gujarat
Shvetambara Sthanakvasi	**Non-image worship**; **sthanakas/prayer halls**; also called Dhundhiya/Sadhumargi; Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab and Haryana associations
Shvetambara Terapantha	**Non-image worship**; disciplined organisation under **one Acharya**, simplicity and meditation; Rajasthan associations

Digambara Terapantha worships images; Shvetambara Terapantha does not. They are different traditions sharing a name. Regional associations are broad, not exclusive modern distribution maps.

13. Buddhism, Jainism and Ajivikas compared

Issue	Buddhism	Jainism
Vedas / birth privilege	Vedas not binding; spiritual worth tied to conduct	Vedas not binding; conduct/knowledge, not Brahmana birth alone
Self	**No permanent atman**	**Individual enduring jivas**
Karma	Intention-driven moral causation	Karmic matter binds soul; stop influx and shed it
Path	**Middle Way**, Eightfold Path	Stricter ascetic discipline, Triratna and vows

Issue	Buddhism	Jainism
Ahimsa	Important; varied food rules	Particularly exacting; strict vegetarianism and minute-life care
Creator	Not required for liberation	No creator; universe eternal/self-regulated
Community	Monks, nuns and lay supporters	Monks, nuns and lay supporters; sect differences about final liberation
Common ground	**Renunciation, self-effort, karma/rebirth, criticism of sacrifice and priestly monopoly**	These similarities do **not** mean identical metaphysics or equal avoidance of severe penance

Ajivikas

- **Makkhali Gosala**, traditionally once a companion of Mahavira; a distinct shramana movement. Traditions speak of many competing teachings—**"62"** is a literary enumeration, not a verified census.
- **Niyati = destiny/determinism**: liberation unfolds through an ordained sequence of rebirths; human effort cannot change that sequence in the account attributed to them. Yet they practised **severe austerities**.
- Their own writings are largely lost; much doctrine survives through **rival Buddhist/Jaina accounts**, requiring caution about hostile characterisations.
- Mauryan patronage, especially **third century BCE** cave dedications at **Barabar/Nagarjuni**, provides important evidence; inscriptions of **Ashoka and Dasharatha** matter more than polemical anecdotes.
- Later southern references continue into medieval times, sometimes cited as late as the **fourteenth century CE**; identification/continuity is debated. Do not mistake Ajivikas for **Ajita Kesakambalin's materialism**.

14. PYQ recall and answer frames

Prelims: group the recurring traps

Theme / years represented in the chapter	Fast answer and reason
2023 Dhanyakataka; souls; stupas	**Andhra; Jainism; two statements correct**—relic repository and commemorative role; exclusive Buddhist origin is false
2022 texts and scholars	Jaina: **Parishishtaparvan + Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana**. **Dignaga—Buddhist; Nathamuni—Vaishnava; Aryadeva—Buddhist**, so two pairs correct
2020 paramitas; school statements	**Perfections for the bodhisattva path**; Lokottaravada offshoot and Mahasanghika influence correct; Sthaviravadins are not Mahayana
2019 Mahayana; 2018 Sthanakvasi/Maitreya	Bodhisattva path, exalted Buddhas, images/rituals; **Jaina sect; future Buddha**
2017 early schools and Padmapani	Sarvastivada statement correct; Sautrantika/Sammitiya not Jaina; **Ajanta**
2016 bodhisattva	Compassion and aid to beings; **not uniquely the central ideal of "Hinayana"**
2014/2015 kingdom question	**Kosala and Magadha only: 2014 option (c), 2015 option (d)**. Official papers have different option orders; the chapter applies one combined layout, so do not reuse its letter across years

Theme / years represented in the chapter	Fast answer and reason
2013 Jain doctrine; cave types; Nirvana	Source key treats all three Jaina propositions as correct in the exam's broad religious wording; distinguish **jiva from non-living pudgala** philosophically. **Chaitya—worship; vihara—residence; Nirvana—extinction of craving**
2012 shared features; Bhumisparsha	Common: rejection of binding Vedic authority/ritual efficacy—not both adopting the Buddhist Middle Way. Earth witnesses Buddha's merit against Mara
2011 creator; 2005 contemporaries	Jaina answer **universal law**; **Milinda/Menander** belongs to a later age than Buddha, Bimbisara and Prasenajit
2004 Kharavela; 2003 family statements	Kharavela's Kalinga patronage correct. Preserve old exam wording separately: **Koliya/Kosala and Chetaka kinship are historically sensitive**, not reasons to rewrite the original question silently
2002 Pavarana; 2001 Kashmir council	End-of-rains correction/confession; **Vasumitra**
2000 ahimsa/agriculture assertion	In the historical exam formulation, agriculture's injury explains the stated constraint; actual Jaina occupational history is more varied than an absolute ban
1998 Eightfold Path; 1997 Milinda; 1996 literature/common ground; 1995 Anuvrata	**Dharmachakrapravartana Sutta; Nagasena; Therigatha is Buddhist; common Veda/ritual criticism + ahimsa; Jainism**

2016 PYQ: memorising chronicles, dynastic histories and epic tales was the profession of **Maagadha (d)**. The year is confirmed from the saved official paper, despite its omission in the chapter. **Undated practice exercises are practice, not PYQs.**

Mains: build analytical answers

- **2016 GS1—Stupa art:** introduce monument as sacred/narrative space → Jatakas and Buddha-life symbols → folk motifs such as trees, animals and fertility figures → compassion, generosity, renunciation and the Dhamma → donors and circumambulation connect belief with social participation. Use **Sanchi/Bharhut/Amaravati**; do not read every motif as only Buddhist or claim all art was royal.
- **2015 History optional—post-Vedic economy and religions:** explain surplus/iron/cattle → urban crafts, coins and merchants → status conflict/patronage → ethical/renouncer answers; qualify economic determinism using intellectual debates, personalities and differing doctrines.
- **2014 History optional—Buddha today:** compassion, non-harm, responsible speech/livelihood, moderation and mindfulness address violence, exclusion and consumption; critically add structural injustice, public policy and material deprivation—individual calm alone cannot resolve them.
- **2014 GS1—Taxila and Nalanda:** Taxila was an ancient learning centre at a strategic northwestern crossroads with renowned teachers and many disciplines; teaching often organised around individual teachers. **Nalanda developed a more integrated residential monastic institution**. Avoid projecting the modern degree-granting university onto either without qualification.
- **2011 History optional—Jaina tenets and humanity:** ahimsa → peaceful coexistence/ecological care; anekantavada/syadavada → dialogue and qualified judgement; aparigraha → restraint; satya/asteya → integrity; end with practical limits and the distinction between ascetic and lay vows.

Last-minute chain

Lumbini → Bodh Gaya → Sarnath → Kushinagar | Four Truths → Eightfold Path → Middle Way → Nirvana.